BASIC OBJECTIVES

It can be said with certainty that certain basic objectives, which enshrine the main principles of Indian foreign policy, have remained unchanged overtime and constitute the pillars of Indian foreign policy. These basic principles are now outlined.

1. *Non-Alignment:* The chief architect of non-aligned policy was Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru, the first Prime Minister of India. His main concern was consolidating the Independence earned after years of struggle and ensuring peace and economic development of India. Nehru's ardent desire, therefore, became an effort to keep India out of 'entangling alliances'. However, the immediate impetus to the formulation of non-alignment was provided by the Cold War between the two superpowers, the United States and the Soviet Union, which divided the world into two hostile camps. Further, the US attempt to rope in a number of Asian countries into various military alliances like the Baghdad Pact (1955–1958), SEATO (1954) and CENTO (1958–1979) as part of their 'containment' policy, and to which India's neighbour Pakistan was also being drawn into, made non-alignment a better option to Nehru.

Nehru professed distancing India from the two power blocs, with the aim of ensuring development and fighting social evils such as poverty, hunger and death. India also preferred to keep away from the power politics of groups aligned against one another which had led in the past to two World Wars, and which might again lead to disasters on an even vaster scale in the future. Nehru felt that "to enter into an alliance was to lose one's independence because at times of emergency the recipient country will have to take orders from the country supplying the arms. Worse still, Asian countries entering into alliance with the West, would give the West an opportunity to solve Asian problems minus Asia".[1]

2. *Anti-Colonialism and Anti-Imperialism:* The roots of India's anti-colonial and anti-imperialistic politics lie in her own experience of British imperialism. The anti-imperialist feeling, which gathered during the Indian freedom movement, through mass struggles such as the Swadeshi Movement, Non-Cooperation Movement, Civil